



School of Accountancy, Economics and Finance



115.112 Accounting

Assessment 3

Business Financial Evaluation

Semester 2, 2026

Please note that this assessment is due
before Sunday, 27 September 2026, 11pm (NZST)
Assessment 3 is marked out of 100 and will contribute 20% to your final grade.

ASSESSMENT 3 INSTRUCTIONS

The assessment will be in two parts:

Part A: Analysing financial statements using Power BI (a Microsoft software application) and a financial discussion.

Part B: Discuss a Māori Business topic.

How to approach this Assessment

- Please read all instructions before starting the assessment.
- Study the relevant material in the textbook and other study materials and make sure you understand the concepts covered.

Before attempting Part A of the Assessment 3

1. Download Power BI Desktop (see the top of the following page for information about the download) **OR** access Power BI through Massey's Virtual Desktop as discussed on the following page and point (3.b.) below. Only Microsoft users can download the application to their devices. If you have an Apple or other non-Microsoft device, you must access the application through Massey's Virtual Desktop.
2. Download the following file from Stream under the Assessment 3 files folder and save it on your device:

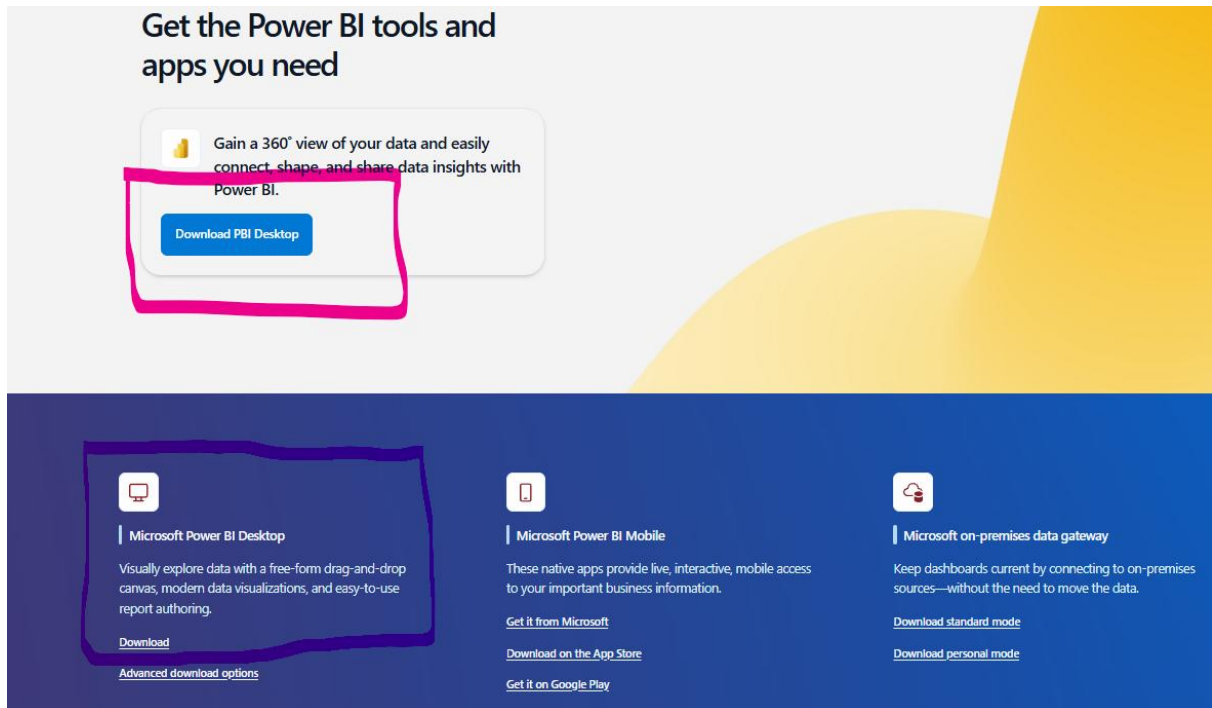
115.112 Data Assessment 3.xlsx
3. Access the material provided for Power BI training under the Assessment Resources section:
 - a. Power BI Recording 1 – A quick run-through using the application
 - b. Power BI Recording 2 – How to access the application through Massey's Virtual Desktop
 - c. Data visualisation slides – a useful resource for requirements (ii) and (iii).
4. You can attempt Part A without the training material if you have prior knowledge of the Power BI application.

Power BI Desktop Download for Microsoft users

Part A of this assessment requires you to complete tasks using Power BI Desktop (It is a free to use program). Please follow this link to download the program:

[Power BI Download](#)

Download the 'Microsoft Power BI Desktop' version as **highlighted** below in the screenshot from the Microsoft website. Either Download link will work.



- After downloading and opening the application, you will be asked to log in. **DO NOT ATTEMPT TO LOG IN USING YOUR MASSEY CREDENTIALS OR ANY OTHER CREDENTIALS.** You can use the application without logging in. Opt out of logging in, by closing the dialogue box. You may need to do this a few times while using this application.
- You are now ready to upload the Excel file (see point 2 on page 2).

Power BI Desktop usage for non-Microsoft users (Apple, etc.)

If you are unable to download Power BI Desktop to your computer, you can access the program by remotely accessing Massey's Virtual Desktop. You will find the complete instructions under the Assessment Resources section on the Stream site. The file is called: 'Power BI Recording 2'.

Submitting the Assessment files

- The assessment will result in 2 separate files: one PDF file and one Word file.
- Submit both files in the provided submission point for Assessment 3.
- Use the following naming convention for the files that you create: use your Last Name and Student ID number as the name of the file [Do not change the file extension or you (and the marker) will not be able to use the file]. For example, if your Last Name is Smith and your Student ID number is 88888888; your files will be Smith88888888.pdf and Smith88888888.docx.
- You must submit your work in the Power BI file in an exported PDF format. See p.6 of this booklet for the instructions or the Power BI Recording 1.
- Once you have started working on an assessment, you should make **backups**. It pays to rename different versions of your work. A simple way to do this is to use the **Save as** file instruction and add a number or letter to the end of the file name. (This allows you to go back to an earlier version.)
- For policies regarding extensions and late submissions, see the Assessment section. Penalties will be applied to late submissions for which an extension has not been granted.

ASSESSMENT BRIEF

PART A: Financial Statements Evaluation:

You work as an investment advisor at a prestigious accountancy firm. You have recently acquired a new client, who has shown some interest in investing in a New Zealand listed company. The client confessed to having very little financial knowledge, and has asked you for advice.

Your assistant has downloaded the 2024 and 2025 financial statements of seven New Zealand companies and has compiled the relevant Statement of Financial Position (Balance Sheet) and Statement of Financial Performance (Income Statement) data in a Microsoft Excel spreadsheet. The file comprises of two (2) sheets, one for the 2024 financial data and one for the 2025 financial data.

To provide your client with comprehensive financial information, you calculate relevant ratios and prepare tables and graphs as a visual presentation of the ratios in the Microsoft application, Power BI. Furthermore, you also prepare simple discussions of the ratios and what the ratios reveal about the companies.

Required:

In Power BI:

Upload the data from the provided Excel file, '115.112 Data Assessment 3.xlsx'. Load the '2024' and '2025' sheets from this file. Use the information in the data sheets in Power BI to calculate the following ratios for all the companies for 2025 (2024 calculations are NOT required) (*Use the amounts as they are provided. All amounts are presented in NZ dollars*).:

(i)

- Profit Margin
- Gross Profit Percentage
- Return on Total Assets
- Return on Owners' Equity
- Inventory Turnover
- Sales % Increase
- Number of Days in Selling Period
- Accounts Receivable Turnover (*Assume all sales are on credit*)
- Number of Days in Collection Period
- Days Payables Outstanding (DPO)
- Cash Conversion Cycle
- Current Ratio
- Quick Ratio
- Debt Ratio
- Interest Coverage

(15 marks)

See the following page for tips on completing this requirement.

- Ensure you are working in the '2025' sheet when calculating the ratios.
- Use the 'New Column' function in the 'Data view' in Power BI to create a new calculated column for each of the ratios.
- See Appendix A for the formulas, p. 10.

- (ii) Present the 2025 ratios in at least four separate tables for each of the four groupings in your Power BI file to compare the companies, in the 'Report view'. The tables must express profitability, efficiency, liquidity and financial gearing appropriately.

(8 marks)

- (iii) Create appropriate graphs in your Power BI file for the 2025 ratios to compare the companies, in the 'Report view'. The graphs must express profitability, efficiency, liquidity and financial gearing appropriately.

(8 marks)

Exporting your tables and graphs from Power BI to a PDF file:

- Once you have completed requirements (i) to (iii) in Power BI, save the file as a .pbix file, then...
 - Open the File menu at the top left of the Screen.
 - Click on Export
 - Click on Export to PDF
 - The application will save your tables and graphs in a PDF file.
 - See the naming convention for the PDF file on p. 4 of this booklet.
 - This is the file you submit for assessment with your Word file.

In a Word document: [Use the same file for requirements (iv), (v), (vi), and (vii)]

Your client noted to have a special interest in milk and vehicles, and accordingly, you prepared a comparative discussion of The a2 Milk Company and Turners Automotive Group.

- (iv) Write a discussion on profitability, including the following:
- Evaluate the profitability of The a2 Milk Company by comparing the company's 2025 results with its results for 2024. *See the table on the following page for the relevant ratios for 2024.*
 - Evaluate the profitability of Turners Automotive Group by comparing the company's 2025 results with their results for 2024. *See the table on the following page for the relevant ratios for 2024.*
 - Compare the profitability of The a2 Milk Company and Turners Automotive Group for 2025.

(30 marks)

- (v) Write a managerial discussion on the cash conversion cycle (CCC) results, including the following:
- Evaluate the CCC of The a2 Milk Company by comparing the company's 2025 results with its results for 2024. *See the table on the following page for the relevant ratios for 2024.*

- Evaluate the CCC of Turners Automotive Group by comparing the company's 2025 results with its results for 2024. *See the table on the following page for the relevant ratios for 2024.*
- Compare the CCC for 2025 of The a2 Milk Company and Turners Automotive Group. **(22 marks)**

	2024	
Ratios	The a2 Milk Company	Turners Automotive Group
Profit Margin	16.92%	11.81%
Gross Profit Percentage	45.81%	57.42%
Return on Total Assets	17.19%	8.96%
Return on Owner's Equity	23.53%	17.91%
Sales % Increase	5.17%	6.97%
Number of Days in Selling Period [Days Inventory Outstanding (DIO)]	75	53
Number of Days in Collection Period [Days Sales Outstanding (DSO)]	17	7
Days Payables Outstanding (DPO)	133	47
Cash Conversion Cycle	-41	13

PART B – Accounting Information for Māori Business:

In a Word document: *[Use the same file for requirements (iv), (v), (vi) and (vii)]*

(vi) Discuss Māori asset ownership objectives. (10 marks)

(vii) Provide references for requirement (vi). (7 marks)

[TOTAL: 100 marks]

See the following page for details on how to present requirements (iv), (v), (vi), and (vii).

Presentation of discussion requirements:

- Answer (iv), (v), (vi), and (vii) in the same Word file.
- Answers should be well reasoned and comprehensive.
- Your answer for (iv) should range from 500 to 600 words.
 - Do not copy the tables and visualisations from (ii) and (iii) into the Word document as part of your discussion. Just refer to the ratio numbers.
 - References are not required.
- Your answer for (v) should range from 400 to 450 words.
 - Do not copy the tables and visualisations from (ii) and (iii) into the Word document as part of your discussion. Just refer to the ratio numbers.
 - References are not required.
- Your answer for (vi) should range from 200 to 250 words. These do not include the references.
 - Consult the provided study material and the internet for information.
 - It is also advisable to add to this material from other literature, e.g. websites from the internet.
 - References are required. Apply the APA 7th ed. method of referencing. For a handy online, interactive tool, [click here](#).
- The discussions of (iv), (v), and (vi) do not need to be presented in the form of reports or essays.
- A good way to limit word usage is by using bullet points.

APPENDIX A: ANALYSIS RATIOS FOR USE WITH CUNNINGHAM

TYPE OF RATIO		REFERENCE 5 th ed.	
PROFITABILITY		Chapter & Page	
1	Profit Margin	Ch. 7 p.339	$\frac{\text{Net Income} \times 100}{\text{Net Sales}}$
2	Gross Profit Percentage	Ch. 7 p.339	$\frac{\text{Gross Profit} \times 100}{\text{Net Sales}}$
3	Return on Total Assets	Ch.8 p.397	$\frac{(\text{Net Income} + \text{Interest Expense}) \times 100}{\text{Average Total Assets}}$
4	Return on Owner's Equity	Ch.8 p.398	$\frac{\text{Net Income} \times 100}{\text{Average Owner's Equity}}$
5	Sales % Increase	Not in text	$\frac{(\text{Sales Year 2} - \text{Sales Year 1}) \times 100}{\text{Sales Year 1}}$
EFFICIENCY			
6	Inventory Turnover	Ch. 8 p.389	$\frac{\text{Cost of Goods Sold}}{\text{Average Inventory}}$
7	Number of Days in Selling Period [Days Inventory Outstanding (DIO)]	Ch. 8 p.390 & Week 5 lecture notes	$\frac{365}{\text{Inventory Turnover}}$
8	Accounts Receivable Turnover (Assume all sales are credit sales)	Ch. 8 p.391	$\frac{\text{Net Credit Sales}}{\text{Average Accounts Receivable}}$
9	Number of Days in Collection Period [Days Sales Outstanding (DSO)]	Ch.8 p.391 & Week 5 lecture notes	$\frac{365}{\text{Accounts Receivable Turnover}}$
10	Days Payables Outstanding (DPO)	Week 5 lecture notes	$\frac{\text{Average Accounts Payable} \times 365}{\text{Cost of Goods Sold}}$
11	Cash Conversion Cycle (CCC)	Week 5 lecture notes	$\text{DIO} + \text{DSO} - \text{DPO}$
LIQUIDITY			
12	Current Ratio	Ch. 8 p.387	$\frac{\text{Current Assets}}{\text{Current Liabilities}}$
13	Quick Ratio	Ch.8 p.388	$\frac{\text{Quick Assets}}{\text{Current Liabilities}}$ Where Quick Assets = Cash + Accounts Receivable + Short Term Marketable Securities + Short Term Notes Receivable
FINANCIAL GEARING			
14	Debt Ratio	Ch. 8 p.394	$\frac{\text{Total Liabilities} \times 100}{\text{Total Assets}}$
15	Interest Coverage	Not in text	$\frac{\text{Net Income} + \text{Interest Expense}}{\text{Interest Expense}}$

Appendix B: Marking Grid

Qualities	Fail	C Pass	B Pass	A Pass	Max Mark
Calculation of ratios (i)	Marks allocated to ratios calculated in Power BI. If a substantial part of workings are correct, part marks may be awarded.				15
Table(s) of the ratios in (ii)	Marks allocated for the tables prepared in Power BI. The tables must appropriately express profitability, efficiency, liquidity and financial gearing. The presentation of tables will also be evaluated.				8
Visualisation of the ratios in (iii)	Marks allocated for the graphs prepared in Power BI. The graphs must appropriately express profitability, efficiency, liquidity and financial gearing. The presentation of graphs will also be evaluated.				8
Addressing requirement (iv)	Work does not address the assessment brief or the focus is very inadequate. 0-14	Work makes some relevant points but is not adequately focused on the assessment brief 15-19	Work displays an understanding of the brief and provides a range of relevant evidence in answering it. 20-23	Work which engages closely with the assessment brief and addresses its implications as well as its “surface sense” 24-30	30
Addressing requirement (v)	Work does not address the assessment brief or the focus is very inadequate. 0-10	Work makes some relevant points but is not adequately focused on the assessment brief 11-13	Work displays an understanding of the brief and provides a range of relevant evidence in answering it. 14-16	Work which engages closely with the assessment brief and addresses its implications as well as its “surface sense” 17-22	22
Addressing requirement (vi)	Work does not address the assessment brief or the focus is very inadequate. 0-4	Work makes some relevant points but is not adequately focused on the assessment brief 5-6	Work displays an understanding of the brief and provides a range of relevant evidence in answering it. 7	Work which engages closely with the assessment brief and addresses its implications as well as its “surface sense” 8-10	10
References (vii)	Marks given for the presence of references and accurate use of APA 7 th ed.				7
Total					100

Assessment Queries

Please feel free to keep in touch with the 115.112 team regarding this assessment. That way, all students benefit and often we have found that the best way of learning is through discussion with your peers as well as teaching staff.

Please note that this assessment is at the individual, not group level. Discussion is fine, but do not post your answers to the assessment on STREAM through discussion forums, as that will lead to penalties. If you are uncertain, please contact the teaching staff.

There are a large number of students in this paper, but that does not mean that you are not individually very important to us. We value each student and will try to provide appropriate guidance to the best of our ability.

Return of marked assessments

You will be informed when your marks are available. A break-down of the mark will be given on a marking sheet, available at the same point where you uploaded your assessment. Note that the normal turnaround of assessments is three working weeks. However, we will be working to return the assessment sooner than that.

There will be feedback in the form of suggested solutions and overall comments by the marker.

All the best with your assessment!

The 115.112 Teaching Te